



FLEET & SHORE PERSONNEL TRAINING

Alcohol Test Equipment Training

Correct use, calibration and record-keeping of alcohol-testing equipment, and the zero-tolerance framework that governs every test result.

STCW Reg. VIII/1

ISM Code

Company Alcohol & Drug Policy

What We Will Cover

01

Company Alcohol Policy

Why the policy exists and the zero-tolerance standard

02

Types of Test Equipment

Breathalyzers, single-use and evidential devices

03

Calibration & Maintenance

Keeping equipment accurate, certified and ready

04

Testing Procedures

Random, pre-duty, post-incident and for-cause testing

05

Recording & Reporting Results

Documentation that stands up to audit and investigation

06

Legal & Disciplinary Framework

STCW, flag-state limits and the consequences of a positive test



SECTION 1

Company Alcohol Policy

Why Glory Ship Management maintains a strict, non-negotiable alcohol and drug policy across the fleet.

01

WHY IT MATTERS

Alcohol and Safe Ship Operation Do Not Mix

Alcohol impairs judgement, reaction time and coordination — exactly the faculties a safe watch depends on.

- Even small amounts of alcohol measurably slow reaction time, narrow attention and impair risk judgement, well before a person appears visibly affected.
- Numerous major maritime casualties have named alcohol or drug impairment among their contributing causes, prompting industry-wide zero-tolerance policies.
- The Company's Alcohol & Drug Policy applies to all officers and ratings, at all times while assigned to a Company vessel, in port and at sea.
- The policy exists to protect the individual, their shipmates, the ship, the cargo and the marine environment — not to punish, but to prevent.
- Every crew member signs acknowledgement of the policy on joining, and it is reviewed at every safety induction and refresher.



Zero Tolerance

The Company operates a strict zero-tolerance policy: any confirmed positive test, at any level above the stated limit, triggers the disciplinary procedure without exception.

THE LIMITS THAT APPLY

Company & Regulatory Alcohol Limits

The Company's own limits are set at or below the strictest limits found in international and flag-state regulation.

0.00%

Blood alcohol concentration permitted for any crew member on watchkeeping duty

0.04%

STCW-referenced upper limit for blood alcohol concentration, never to be approached

0.19mg/L

STCW-referenced upper limit for breath alcohol concentration, treated as an absolute ceiling

Drinking, Duty and Rest

The policy sets clear boundaries around any consumption of alcohol at all, not only around the legal limit.



Do

- Treat the Company policy as a complete prohibition on duty, not a limit to drink up to
- Allow a full, unhurried recovery period before any watch or safety-critical duty
- Report to the Master if you believe you, or a colleague, may be unfit for duty
- Ask the Master or DPA if you are ever unsure whether the policy applies to a situation



Don't

- Don't consume alcohol at all while assigned to a Company vessel, except where shore leave policy expressly permits it ashore
- Don't assume a night's sleep alone clears alcohol from your system
- Don't attempt to mask consumption or delay a requested test
- Don't pressure a colleague to cover for suspected impairment



SECTION 2

Types of Test Equipment

The devices carried aboard for alcohol testing, and when each is used.

02

Devices Carried Aboard

Every Company vessel carries approved alcohol-testing equipment appropriate to its crew size and testing programme.



Electronic Breathalyzer

A hand-held fuel-cell or infrared device giving a fast, quantitative breath alcohol reading, used for the majority of routine testing.



Single-Use Screening Test

A disposable, chemical-reaction breath tube giving a simple pass/fail indication, useful as a rapid first screen.



Evidential-Grade Device

A higher-precision instrument, calibrated to a traceable standard, used to confirm a result that may lead to disciplinary or legal action.



Saliva / Oral Fluid Test Kit

Used where the Company's programme also screens for drugs alongside alcohol, following the same chain-of-custody principles.

Matching Equipment to the Situation

Not every testing situation calls for the same device — screening and confirmatory testing serve different purposes.

- Routine and random testing is typically carried out with the vessel's calibrated electronic breathalyzer, giving a documented numeric result.
- A single-use screening tube may be used as an initial, rapid check, but a positive or borderline screen should always be confirmed on the calibrated device.
- Post-incident and for-cause testing should always use the evidential-grade device where the vessel carries one, given the weight the result may carry.
- Mouthpieces are single-use and must be replaced between every individual test, without exception, to prevent cross-contamination and ensure hygiene.
- Equipment should never be shared between vessels without being recalibrated and recertified on arrival.



Read the Manual

Every device has a manufacturer's operating procedure — warm-up time, sample volume, waiting period after eating or drinking — that must be followed exactly for a reliable result.



SECTION 3

Calibration & Maintenance

03

An alcohol-testing device is only as trustworthy as its last calibration.

Keeping Results Defensible

An uncalibrated device can produce a false result in either direction — missing a genuinely impaired crew member, or wrongly accusing a sober one.

- Breathalyzers must be calibrated against a certified reference gas or standard at the interval specified by the manufacturer, typically every six to twelve months.
- The vessel's calibration certificate must be current, kept with the device, and produced on request during any PSC, vetting or internal audit.
- A device used past its calibration due date, or showing a failed self-check, must be taken out of service immediately and the Company notified.
- Sensor drift, battery condition and mouthpiece supply should all be checked as part of routine equipment inspection, not only at calibration time.
- A designated officer — typically the Safety Officer or Chief Officer — should be assigned responsibility for the testing equipment's calibration schedule.



Function Check Before Use

A quick self-test or zero-check before each testing session confirms the device is responding correctly — a habit that costs seconds and protects the credibility of every result.

MAINTENANCE SCHEDULE

Routine Care of Test Equipment

A simple maintenance routine keeps equipment reliable between formal calibrations.

Task	Frequency	Responsible
Function / zero self-check	Before each testing session	Testing officer
Mouthpiece stock check	Weekly	Safety Officer
Battery / power check	Monthly	Safety Officer
Full calibration against reference standard	Per manufacturer schedule (typically 6-12 months)	Chief Officer / shore technician

Looking After the Equipment

Correct storage protects both the device's accuracy and its calibration status.



Do

- Store devices in a clean, dry case away from extremes of heat or cold
- Keep the calibration certificate and log together with the device
- Report any physical damage, error message or failed self-check immediately
- Replace mouthpieces, batteries and consumables from approved stock only



Don't

- Don't use a device that has failed its self-check or is past calibration due date
- Don't expose the sensor to smoke, solvent vapour or extreme humidity
- Don't attempt to adjust or repair internal components onboard
- Don't continue testing with a device once any fault has been noted



SECTION 4

Testing Procedures

When testing happens, and how to carry it out fairly, safely and consistently.

04

CATEGORIES OF TESTING

When a Test Is Carried Out

The Company's programme uses four categories of testing, each with its own purpose and trigger.



Random Testing

Unannounced testing of a randomly selected sample of the crew, carried out at unpredictable intervals to deter and detect.



Pre-Duty Testing

Testing before taking over a safety-critical watch or duty, particularly following shore leave or a port call.



Post-Incident Testing

Mandatory testing of relevant personnel following any accident, injury, near miss or pollution incident.



For-Cause Testing

Testing triggered by a reasonable, documented suspicion of impairment based on behaviour, appearance or odour.

CONDUCTING A TEST

Running a Fair and Consistent Test

A consistent procedure protects both the integrity of the result and the dignity of the person being tested.

- Confirm the individual has not consumed food, drink or mouth spray in the 15-20 minutes before testing, as residual substances can distort a breath reading.
- Explain the procedure to the person being tested, including their right to a witnessed retest if they dispute the result.
- The test should be conducted by a trained officer, in a private location, with a witness present wherever practicable.
- A single-use mouthpiece is fitted immediately before the test and disposed of immediately after, in view of the person being tested.
- Where the first reading is at or above the Company limit, a second confirmatory test should be taken after a short waiting interval, per the device manual.



Fairness and Dignity

Testing is a safety measure, not a punishment in itself — conducting it calmly, privately and consistently protects both the crew member and the integrity of the programme.

Requesting a For-Cause Test

For-cause testing carries particular sensitivity and should always be handled with care and documentation.



Do

- Document the specific, observable behaviour that raised the suspicion before requesting the test
- Involve a second officer as a witness wherever the situation allows
- Remove the individual from safety-critical duty immediately, pending the result
- Treat the individual respectfully and keep the matter confidential outside those who need to know



Don't

- Don't request a for-cause test based on rumour or a single unverified report
- Don't discuss the suspicion or the result with crew who have no need to know
- Don't allow the individual to continue safety-critical duty while awaiting the result
- Don't skip written documentation, even if the result is later found negative



SECTION 5

Recording & Reporting Results

05

A test is only as good as the record that supports it.

What Every Test Record Must Contain

A complete, contemporaneous record is essential — both to support the result and to protect everyone involved if it is later questioned.

- Every test, whatever the category or result, is logged: date, time, device used, testing officer, person tested and the numeric reading obtained.
- The reason for the test (random selection, pre-duty, post-incident, for-cause) must be recorded alongside the result.
- Both the testing officer and the person tested should sign the record, with a witness signature added wherever one was present.
- A negative result is recorded and filed exactly as carefully as a positive one — the record protects the crew member as much as the Company.
- Test records are confidential and held separately from general personnel files, accessible only to those with a legitimate need.



Confidentiality

Alcohol test results are sensitive personal data — share them only with the Master, the DPA and those directly involved in any resulting procedure.

REPORTING CHAIN

Who Sees a Positive Result, and When

A positive or refused test follows a defined, prompt reporting chain.

Step	Action	Responsible
Immediate	Remove individual from duty; secure the record and device reading	Testing officer / Master
Within hours	Report to the Company via the DPA, per the SMS non-conformity procedure	Master
Within 24 hours	Written incident report filed, including test record and witness statements	Master / Safety Officer
Follow-up	Company reviews the case and confirms next steps under the disciplinary procedure	Fleet HR / DPA



SECTION 6

Legal & Disciplinary Framework

The regulatory backbone behind the policy, and the consequences that follow a confirmed positive result.

06

Where the Limits Come From

The Company's policy sits on top of, and is at least as strict as, the applicable international and flag-state requirements.

- STCW Section A-VIII/1 sets internationally referenced limits on blood and breath alcohol concentration for personnel performing designated safety duties.
- Flag states and port states may set their own, sometimes stricter, limits and testing requirements — the most restrictive applicable limit always governs.
- Port State Control officers may request evidence of the Company's alcohol policy and testing records during an inspection.
- A ship found to have a crew member over the applicable limit while on duty can face detention, fines and reputational damage, independent of any individual consequence.
- The Company's policy is written into the SMS and forms part of every seafarer's contract of employment.



No Exceptions

Rank, seniority, length of service and operational pressure are never grounds for an exception to the alcohol policy or its testing procedures.

CONSEQUENCES

What Follows a Confirmed Positive Test

The disciplinary procedure is applied consistently, in line with the Company's published policy.



What Happens

- Immediate suspension from safety-critical duty and, typically, from the vessel
- A formal Company investigation following the SMS non-conformity process
- Referral to the flag state where regulation requires it
- Disciplinary action up to and including dismissal, per the Company's policy



What Does Not Happen

- The matter is not handled informally or 'off the record'
- A first offence does not automatically avoid serious consequences
- The individual is not left without support — welfare and, where applicable, rehabilitation referral are offered
- The case is not discussed outside those with a legitimate need to know

KEY TAKEAWAYS

What Every Crew Member Should Remember

Three principles that summarise this entire course.

Zero

Tolerance — the Company's limits are absolute, with no exception for rank or circumstance

Accurate

Every device must be calibrated, checked and used exactly per procedure to be trusted

Fair

Every test, whatever its result, is conducted and recorded consistently and respectfully



COURSE COMPLETE

A reliable test, correctly performed and honestly recorded, protects every life aboard.

Company DPA — 24/7 emergency line

Fleet HR & Crewing Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr

Fleet Safety Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr